



ALI JADALLAH Anadolu

PALESTINIANS wait to receive meals on Monday from a charity in Gaza, where Israel has cut off most aid.

Israelis call images of starvation in Gaza fake, rebuffing Trump

WASHINGTON — The Israeli government is defending a top military officer who dismissed images of starving Palestinians as “fake” over the weekend, despite President Trump stating Monday that he believes the pictures are real.

The rupture comes amid growing international pressure on Israel over dire circumstances in the Palestinian enclave, and as two Israeli human rights groups, in a first, characterized the Israeli operation in Gaza as a genocide.

In recent days, photographs and videos of desperate Palestinians crowding aid stations and of emaciated children have spread across the globe. Even so, Israel’s prime minister, Benjamin Netanyahu, said Sunday that “there is no starvation in Gaza.”

Photos that have outraged the world are ‘distributed by Hamas,’ says a military official

By Michael Wilner

And on Sunday, during a media tour of a small area of the Gaza Strip, Effie Defrin, a commanding officer and Israel Defense Forces spokesman, told reporters that visuals emerging from Gaza were “breaking our hearts.”

“But most of it is fake — fake — distributed by Hamas,” Defrin said. “It’s a campaign. Unfortunately, some of the Israeli media, including some of the international media, is distributing this information and those false pictures, and creating an image of starvation which doesn’t exist.”

Trump rejected that explanation Monday, telling reporters during a visit to Scotland that the United States would increase its efforts to get food into the territory. “That’s real starvation,” he said. “I see it, [See Gaza, A6]

UC admits a record number of Californians

In-state tally rises 7% as foreign students see a 17% bump. Diversity remains strong.

By JAWEED KALEEM

UC admitted its largest class of California undergraduates for fall 2025, while also maintaining a diverse student body and increasing the number of students who are the first generation in their family to attend college, according to preliminary data released Monday.

The University of California also offered admission to 17% more undergraduate international students, a group that has come under scrutiny from the Trump administration with increased vetting and visa delays.

The strategy in raising international student admits took into account that UC raised nonresident tuition fees last year and that White House actions will probably mean fewer foreigners will decide to study in the U.S. in the fall. The bigger pool of admission offers aims to capture a large enough

group of students who will enroll and bring the international diversity UC values — as well as boost coffers with the full-price tuition paid by non-California residents.

Overall, UC admitted 100,947 first-year California students, up more than 7% from last year. The number represents the largest admitted class to the nation’s premier public university system as leaders address public demands to give more seats to Californians — despite the allure of charging higher tuition to out-of-state students during tough budgetary times.

UC is grappling with a hiring freeze, layoffs, deferred state funding, campus-level structural deficits, potentially costly union contract negotiations and talk of tuition increases. Questions loom over billions in federal grants amid Trump administration claw-backs and multiple federal government investigations probing allegations regarding anti-semitism, use of race in admissions and sources of foreign funding.

The system-wide admission rate for California first- [See UC, A14]

Casino shooting in Reno kills 3; suspect in custody

Others are critically injured in the morning violence at the city’s Grand Sierra Resort.

By SUMMER LIN

A gunman opened fire Monday morning at one of Reno’s biggest casino and hotel complexes, killing three people and injuring several others before being shot and taken into custody by police, officials said.

The violence rocked Reno’s sprawling resort district and left investigators trying to piece together what happened and determine a motive for the shooting.

The shooting reportedly occurred at the parking lot of the Grand Sierra Resort.

At a news conference Monday afternoon, Sparks Police Chief Chris Crawforth said the unidentified gun-

man walked through a parking lot from the north and emerged at the casino’s valet area. As he approached a group of people there, he pulled out the gun and tried to open fire, but the gun initially malfunctioned, police said. The man then got the firearm working and began shooting.

One of the people shot there died at the scene and another died later at the hospital. Two of the other victims were listed in critical condition Monday afternoon, and a third person was treated at the hospital and released.

The gunman fled through the parking lot and opened fire on a security guard, who returned fire, Crawforth said. As the gunman continued fleeing, he encountered a vehicle moving through the parking lot and opened fire, killing the driver, police said. Soon after, police arrived. [See Reno, A6]

Trump shortens deadline for Russia

By WILL WEISERT

EDINBURGH, Scotland — President Trump said Monday that he is giving Russian President Vladimir Putin 10 to 12 days to stop the killing in Ukraine, shortening a 50-day deadline he had given the Russian leader two weeks ago.

Russia fired an overnight barrage of more than 300 drones, four cruise missiles and three ballistic missiles, the Ukrainian air force said, as the bombardment of Ukrainian cities continued despite Trump’s pressure for it to end. U.S.-led peace efforts have also failed to gain momentum.

Trump had said July 14 that he would implement “severe tariffs” on Russia un- [See Russia, A4]



ANDRIY ZHYHAYLO Oboz.ua/Global Images Ukraine

A RUSSIAN drone damaged an apartment building Monday in Kyiv, Ukraine.

California, others suing USDA over SNAP data demand

By KEVIN RECTOR

California and a coalition of other liberal-led states filed a federal lawsuit Monday challenging the U.S. Department of Agriculture’s recent demand that they turn over the personal information of millions of people receiving federal food assistance through the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program.

USDA Secretary Brooke Rollins informed states this month that they would have to transmit the data to the USDA’s Food and Nutrition Service to comply with an executive order by President Trump. That order demanded that Trump’s agency appointees receive “full and prompt access” to all data associated with federal programs, so that they might identify and eliminate “waste, fraud, and abuse.”

Last week, USDA officials informed state SNAP

directors that the deadline for submitting the data is Wednesday and that failure to comply “may trigger non-compliance procedures” — including the withholding of funds.

In announcing the states’ lawsuit Monday, California Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta said the “unprecedented” demand “violates all kinds of state and federal privacy laws” and “further breaks the trust between the federal government and the people it serves.”

Bonta’s office noted that states have administered the equivalent of SNAP benefits — formerly known as food stamps — for 60 years. It said that California alone receives “roughly \$1 billion a year” to administer the program in the state and that “any delay in that funding could be catastrophic for the state and its residents who rely on SNAP to put food on the table.” [See SNAP, A14]



DAMIAN DOVARGANES Associated Press

ILLEGAL TACTICS?

An appellate court appears poised to side with federal judge who blocked immigration agents from conducting “roving patrols.” **NATION, A5**

State considers redistricting
Democrats, eyeing moves in Texas, may revamp congressional maps in their favor. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather
Turning sunny. L.A. Basin: 84/63. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A13**

EV tax credit will soon go away
U.S. will stop paying a \$7,500 incentive for new electric vehicles on Sept. 30. **BUSINESS, A10**

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WALLIS ANNENBERG, 1939 – 2025

A philanthropist who enriched L.A. culture

She donated to arts, education and animal causes, with venues bearing her name.

By DEBORAH VANKIN

Her name is ubiquitous in public spaces around Los Angeles: the Wallis Annenberg Building at the California Science Center in Exposition Park, the Wallis Annenberg Center for the Performing Arts in Beverly Hills, the soon-to-debut Wallis Annenberg Wildlife Crossing in Agoura Hills.

Then there’s the Annenberg Community Beach House in Santa Monica and Wallis Annenberg Gen-Space in Koreatown.

Wallis Annenberg, a deep-pocketed philanthropist who helped trans-



HAMISH ROBERTSON

LIFE OF SERVICE
Wallis Annenberg led family’s foundation.

form the city through massive donations to arts, education and animal welfare causes, died Monday morning at her home in Los Angeles from complications related to lung cancer, the family said. She was 86.

“Wallis transitioned peacefully and comfortably [See Annenberg, A11]